

Lesson 9: Phonogram a

Stage 1 · Lesson 9 · phonogram-intro

Warm-Up: Phonogram Flash Review

Adult: Flash previously taught phonogram cards.

Child says ALL sounds within 2 seconds.

Phonograms to review

(This is your first phonogram lesson! Skip review today.)

New Learning: Your New Phonogram — a

The Phonogram a

a

a says 3 sounds: /ă/ /ā/ /ä/

Sound	Example Words
/ă/	at, cat, hat
/ā/	nation, acorn
/ä/	father, spa

Important: Always teach ALL sounds from the start. Never teach "a says /ă/" and add more later. The child must know that **a** can say 3 different things.

How to Write a

1. Start at the midline.
2. Curve around to make a circle (counter-clockwise).
3. Go up and down in a straight line.

Write **a** three times on your whiteboard or in a sand tray. Say "/ă/ /ā/ /ä/" each time you write it.

Vowel or Consonant?

a is a **vowel**. You can sing it! Your mouth is open. Your lips, tongue, and teeth don't block the sound.

Spelling Analysis

Follow the 5-step routine for each word:

1. **Hear & Say** — Adult says the word, uses it in a sentence. Child repeats.
2. **Segment** — Child breaks the word into individual sounds. Adult holds up fingers (1 finger = 1-letter phonogram).
3. **Write** — Child writes the word while sounding it out.
4. **Analyze** — Underline multi-letter phonograms. Name any spelling rules.
5. **Read** — Child reads the word sound by sound, then blends.

Word	Phonograms Used	Rules Applied	Say-to-Spell
at	a (/ă/), t (/t/)	Short vowel — closed syllable	/ăt/
am	a (/ă/), m (/m/)	Short vowel — closed syllable	/ăm/
an	a (/ă/), n (/n/)	Short vowel — closed syllable	/ăn/

Reading Practice

Read these words sound by sound, then blend:

at am an ad ag

Handwriting Practice

Write each letter once. Say its sounds as you write.

a

a

a

a

a

Quick Check

1. What did you learn today? (*A new phonogram: a*)
 2. What sounds does **a** say? (/ă/ /ā/ /ä/)
 3. Write the word "at" from dictation.
-

Next lesson: Lesson 10: Phonogram d

Practice at home: Flash your new a card 5 times. Find a in a book or on a sign.

 Phonogram a — Teacher Script — *Teacher Script*

> ****Say:**** "Today we are going to learn a new phonogram. A phonogram is a letter or group of letters that makes one or more sounds."

a

Say: "This is the phonogram **a**." (*Point to the card.*) "It says /ă/ /ā/ /ä/."

Say: "Listen to me say its sounds: /ă/ /ā/ /ä/. Now you say them."

(*Child repeats.*)

Say: "Good. Now let's write it. Watch me first." (*Demonstrate writing a.*)

Say: "Now you write **a** three times. Say '/ă/ /ā/ /ä/' each time you write it."

(*Child writes on whiteboard. Check formation.*)

Say: "Every time you see this phonogram, you will try each of its sounds until the word makes sense. Let's practice with some words."

Say: "What did you learn today?" (*Child responds: "The phonogram a — it says /ă/ /ā/ /ä/."*)

Open-source. MIT licensed. Phonograms are drawn from the public-domain phonics tradition (1800s onward).

 **Printable pack:** [packs/stage-1/pg-a.pdf](https://openphonograms.org/packs/stage-1/pg-a.pdf) — lesson + worksheet + flash cards